

Improved AI and beef water usage comparison graphs, now a live page with clickable source links

Posted by u/ram_altman • 0 points • 9 comments

The code is now on github, I will continue to improve this and add more resource comparisons in the future. I have now added data for both the Azure Deepseek and local Chinese Deepseek models to demonstrate that the hosting stack can be more important than model type. I also fixed the graphs to be properly proportional, I think. I'm pretty tired again so I still need to proofread how I did some of it once I get some sleep. As I mentioned before I would like to do greenhouse emissions and energy use, and I think I should also be able to do things like image and video generation once I gather the data. Still a work in progress. I am open to suggestions or corrections.

Comments

u/OGRITHIK • 2 points • 2026-02-27 10:54 UTC

The fact that this is getting downvoted to shit tells you everything you need to know about antis.

u/ram_altman • 3 points • 2026-02-27 11:15 UTC

<https://preview.redd.it/ptp7ozsit0mg1.png?width=687&format=png&auto=webp&s=b4603d04a1f8739d3553af3f8ccf508775729d64>

6k upvotes

u/Whilpin • 2 points • 2026-02-27 09:50 UTC

So my estimations were correct that my consumer hardware, despite being just last gen (RTX 4070), is laughably inefficient per AI task compared to dedicated AI hardware.

u/ram_altman • 3 points • 2026-02-27 10:35 UTC

Every time someone makes a post about this, it gets dogpiled by sock puppets (or maybe just morons) claiming that this is common knowledge and downvoted to oblivion by people crying "strawman".

[https://www.reddit.com/r/aiwars/comments/1q6b0n1/the_local_ai_is_greener_myth/]
(https://www.reddit.com/r/aiwars/comments/1q6b0n1/the_local_ai_is_greener_myth/)

u/not_food • 3 points • 2026-02-27 05:36 UTC

Presenting it that way will confuse the antis, it hides the bigger picture. Showing the total numbers for water usage in % is clearer. Isn't it something like 75% for agriculture compared to just 0.4% for data centers?

u/ram_altman • 3 points • 2026-02-27 10:44 UTC

I can do total water use across industries, but I liked presenting this way because you will have people argue "Well I eat less meat than the average person so I'm doing my part, and both are bad", despite the fact that the data shows that even eating some beef is basically like dumping a barrel of toxic waste in a pond while complaining about the car battery someone threw in there.

But yeah, I can do total numbers in a separate graph. Dairy and beef are obscene compared to AI and completely unsustainable, with no plan to reign them in before we run out of water (not an exaggeration, this is really, literally happening). With AI, we could pass a law tomorrow demanding closed loop cooling be mandated by law, and virtually the entire problem of water use on AI's side could be solved in a few years.

u/Latimas • 1 points • 2026-02-27 04:26 UTC

are you accounting for electricity water use, not just cooling?

u/ram_altman • 3 points • 2026-02-27 04:32 UTC

<https://arxiv.org/pdf/2505.09598>

To capture infrastructure-level overhead in data center operations, we apply three standard environmental multipliers: Power Usage Effectiveness (PUE) [19, 20], Water Usage Effectiveness (WUE)

[19, 20], and Carbon Intensity Factor (CIF) [21, 22].

PUE accounts for non-computational energy overheads such as cooling, lighting, and power distribution. Defined as the ratio of total data center energy consumption to IT-specific energy use.

WUE captures the water used per kilowatt-hour of IT energy, encompassing on-site cooling (Scope

1), off-site electricity generation (Scope 2), and embodied water from hardware manufacturing and

transport (Scope 3). WUE can be computed based on either water withdrawal (the total volume drawn from natural or municipal sources) or water consumption (the portion of withdrawn water permanently lost, primarily through evaporation).

CIF measures carbon emissions per kilowatt-hour of energy consumed, largely driven by the regional

electricity mix. Emissions are categorized as direct on-site combustion (Scope 1), off-site electricity

generation (Scope 2), and embodied emissions from manufacturing and transport (Scope 3).

u/Latimas • 1 points • 2026-02-27 04:51 UTC

yeahh I think I just caught dyslexia